

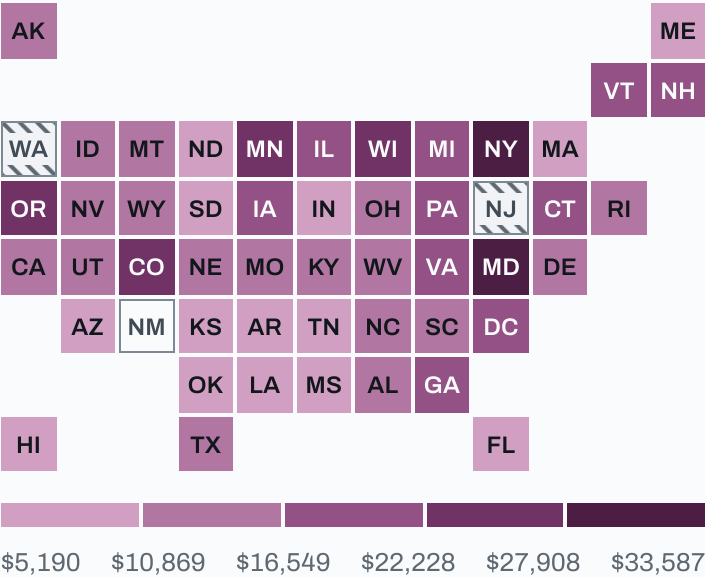
What a raise costs, state by state

Fifty-one sets of rules, eleven household shapes, one earnings scale — from \$0 past 400% of the poverty line for that household. Each figure is the worst single \$1,000 step of earnings in that state's curve for that household — how much net income falls when pay goes up by a thousand dollars.

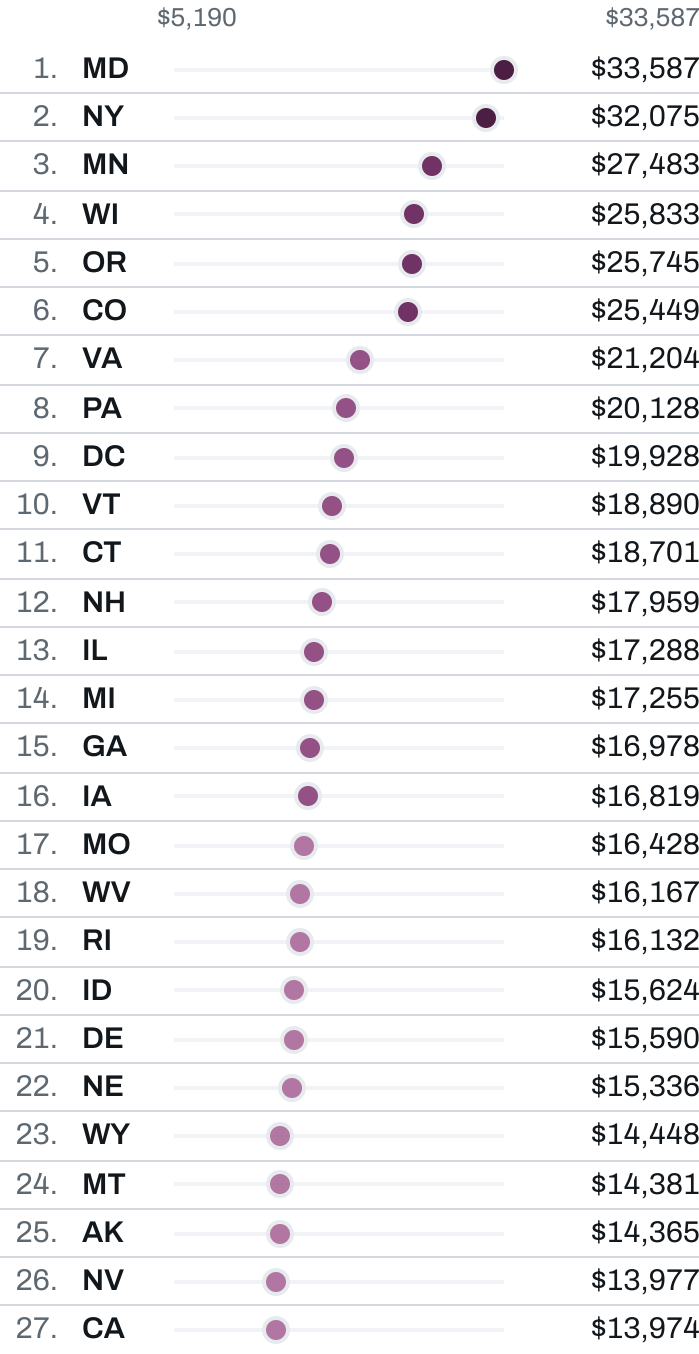
A *cliff* is a \$1,000 raise that cuts net income by \$200 or more; a *danger zone* is a run of earnings across which the household never gets ahead. The figures come from [PolicyEngine](#), an open-source tax-and-benefit calculator, run by HotGap. Estimates only.

Largest one-step loss, by state

1 adult, 2 children (3 and 7). Net income lost in the worst single \$1,000 step of earnings.



Ranked



Corrections applied — choose a state

Select a state on the map or in the table to read what HotGap changed on top of PolicyEngine before its figures were read.

28.	TX		\$13,938
29.	AL		\$12,584
30.	OH		\$12,062
31.	KY		\$11,922
32.	SC		\$11,497
33.	UT		\$11,432
34.	NC		\$11,153
35.	AZ		\$10,859
36.	ND		\$10,554
37.	MA		\$10,370
38.	AR		\$10,226
39.	KS		\$10,044
40.	LA		\$9,649
41.	ME		\$8,110
42.	HI		\$7,689
43.	IN		\$6,951
44.	MS		\$6,337
45.	SD		\$6,334
46.	OK		\$6,103
47.	FL		\$5,795
48.	TN		\$5,190

No cliff found (1)

NM		no cliff
No step down of \$200 or more anywhere on this household's curve. A measurement of zero, not the smallest loss: these states are left out of the bins.		

Not ranked — figures incomplete (2)

NJ		not comparable
WA		not comparable

NJ Health Plan Savings and Cascade Care Savings are not modelled here, so a real cliff may be missing from these curves. They are not low states; they are unmeasured ones.

Bins are recomputed for every measure — equal-width steps of a dollar measure, classes of whole numbers for a count — so a shade means nothing across two different measures. Read the bin bounds, not the colour.

All 51, every measure

State	Largest one-step loss	Danger zone width	The leap	Safe exit	Cliffs	Deferred	Figures
AK	\$14,365	\$75,000	\$45,000	\$136,000	6	0	complete
AL	\$12,584	\$57,000	\$42,000	\$113,000	6	1	complete
AR	\$10,226	\$48,000	\$19,000	\$120,000	7	0	complete
AZ	\$10,859	\$47,000	\$40,000	\$109,000	6	0	complete
CA	\$13,974	\$80,000	\$55,000	\$142,000	8	0	complete
CO	\$25,449	\$90,000	\$73,000	\$119,000	10	0	complete
CT	\$18,701	\$82,000	\$54,000	\$131,000	8	0	complete
DC	\$19,928	\$83,000	\$52,000	\$133,000	7	0	complete
DE	\$15,590	\$66,000	\$52,000	\$117,000	6	1	complete
FL	\$5,795	\$43,000	\$27,000	\$116,000	7	0	complete
GA	\$16,978	\$56,000	\$48,000	\$114,000	5	0	complete
HI	\$7,689	\$58,000	\$37,000	\$116,000	5	1	complete
IA	\$16,819	\$46,000	\$44,000	\$108,000	5	1	complete
ID	\$15,624	\$48,000	\$34,000	\$109,000	5	1	complete
IL	\$17,288	\$64,000	\$32,000	\$110,000	8	0	complete
IN	\$6,951	\$47,000	\$38,000	\$108,000	9	0	complete
KS	\$10,044	\$56,000	\$33,000	\$113,000	8	0	complete
KY	\$11,922	\$43,000	\$22,000	\$112,000	4	0	complete
LA	\$9,649	\$51,000	\$17,000	\$114,000	10	0	complete
MA	\$10,370	\$69,000	\$38,000	\$144,000	6	0	complete
MD	\$33,587	\$62,000	≥ \$53,000	past the axis	4	0	complete
ME	\$8,110	\$64,000	\$22,000	\$143,000	9	0	complete
MI	\$17,255	\$63,000	\$55,000	\$110,000	6	0	complete
MN	\$27,483	\$66,000	\$66,000	\$120,000	4	0	complete
MO	\$16,428	\$61,000	\$52,000	\$110,000	12	0	complete
MS	\$6,337	\$38,000	\$12,000	\$113,000	7	0	complete
MT	\$14,381	\$60,000	\$54,000	\$112,000	5	0	complete

State	Largest one-step loss	Danger zone width	The leap	Safe exit	Cliffs	Deferred	Figures
NC	\$11,153	\$54,000	\$47,000	\$113,000	5	0	complete
ND	\$10,554	\$36,000	\$18,000	\$108,000	7	0	complete
NE	\$15,336	\$74,000	\$44,000	past the axis	9	0	complete
NH	\$17,959	\$44,000	\$27,000	\$135,000	4	1	complete
NJ floor	\$26,206 (floor)	\$75,000 (floor)	\$62,000 (floor)	\$111,000 (floor)	7 (floor)	1 (floor)	floor: NJ Health Plan Savings not modelled
NM	none	none	none	none	0	0	complete
NV	\$13,977	\$57,000	\$55,000	\$108,000	5	1	complete
NY	\$32,075	\$68,000	≥ \$55,000	past the axis	4	1	complete
OH	\$12,062	\$57,000	\$47,000	\$110,000	10	0	complete
OK	\$6,103	\$44,000	\$26,000	\$112,000	9	0	complete
OR	\$25,745	\$81,000	\$67,000	\$120,000	15	1	complete
PA	\$20,128	\$46,000	\$34,000	\$110,000	5	1	complete
RI	\$16,132	\$59,000	\$33,000	\$110,000	8	0	complete
SC	\$11,497	\$45,000	\$22,000	\$113,000	7	0	complete
SD	\$6,334	\$35,000	\$14,000	\$112,000	6	0	complete
TN	\$5,190	\$35,000	\$13,000	\$114,000	6	1	complete
TX	\$13,938	\$47,000	\$24,000	\$116,000	5	0	complete
UT	\$11,432	\$48,000	\$27,000	\$113,000	7	0	complete
VA	\$21,204	\$63,000	\$37,000	\$136,000	5	0	complete
VT	\$18,890	\$82,000	\$42,000	\$148,000	19	0	complete
WA floor	\$19,614 (floor)	\$63,000 (floor)	\$49,000 (floor)	\$119,000 (floor)	6 (floor)	1 (floor)	floor: Cascade Care Savings not modelled
WI	\$25,833	\$86,000	\$76,000	\$116,000	7	1	complete
WV	\$16,167	\$64,000	\$30,000	\$132,000	6	0	complete
WY	\$14,448	\$60,000	\$23,000	\$128,000	7	0	complete

Every row keeps the number the model returned, including the rows it cannot complete, because a reporter needs to see what came back. Those

rows are flagged in the last column and are not shaded on the map or placed in the ranking. Select a state on the map or in this table to read the corrections behind its numbers under the map; the arrow keys move between states and Enter selects.

How these numbers were made

- Every cell is one household shape run through [PolicyEngine](#), an open-source tax-and-benefit calculator, at 2026 rules, earnings varied in \$1,000 steps from \$0 past 400% of the poverty guideline for that household size, plus \$40,000 of room to recover.
- The money line is **health-adjusted**: household net income minus what the household actually pays in health-insurance premiums, net of the marketplace subsidy. Deductibles and copays are not included.
- Each household is a typical renter in the state's most populous county — named under the map for the selected state — with HUD Fair Market Rent, Census county estimates, and the DOL National Database of Childcare Prices preschool price for that county, carried to 2026 dollars by the BLS Employment Cost Index. The study year behind the price, and whether a state or national median stood in for a county the database lacks, differ by state and are printed in the source line under the map.
- The CCDF child care subsidy is **on** for this run and off for a household's own lookup. Head Start and housing vouchers are off in both: they are rationed, and assuming a family holds one inflates its numbers.
- Cliffs deferred to a future renewal — Head Start's program-year carry-over, a child's 12 months of continuous Medicaid or CHIP eligibility, a parent's Transitional Medical Assistance — are counted in the *deferred* column and are lifted out of every other figure here. They are real losses; they do not land in the year of the raise.
- Where a state's figure needed a correction on top of PolicyEngine — a premium ladder applied locally, the child care subsidy added back into net income, a parent Medicaid limit taken from the state's handbook, a coverage-gap premium — it is listed under the map for the selected state, from the run's own coverage record, not from copy kept here.
- The download is the table's rows in the table's order, one per state, with these columns: state, state_name, archetype_id, archetype, biggest_one_step_loss, biggest_loss_at, biggest_loss_programs, danger_zone_width, leap, safe_exit, cliff_count, deferred_cliff_count, leap_is_lower_bound, no_cliff_found, comparable, figures, unmodeled_programs, corrections_applied, county_name, county_fips, rent_vintage, county_vintage, childcare_price_vintage, policy_year,

sweep_generated, model_label, model_endpoint, model_version, source. Empty dollar cells are a state with no cliff or a safe exit past the axis; the flags say which figures are floors or lower bounds.

What the model does not include

- Immigration status, assets, and household members aged 65 or over are not inputs.
- Alaska and Hawaii marketplace subsidies are computed upstream against the 48-state poverty guideline rather than their own higher ones ([reported to PolicyEngine](#)). HotGap does not correct this, so both states' premium-driven figures are understated.
- LIHEAP, in every state: Not counted anywhere: HotGap does not request LIHEAP from PolicyEngine, and the few state programs the engine models never reach its net income figure.
- A program the model cannot compute in a state is listed under the map for that state and hatches it on every measure it could move. For 1 adult, 2 children (3 and 7) today that is NJ Health Plan Savings in New Jersey and Cascade Care Savings in Washington.

Hatched is not low. A program the model cannot compute in a state — today NJ Health Plan Savings and Cascade Care Savings — is missing from every figure for it, so its numbers are floors, not measurements. Do not write that those states are gentler; the only honest claim is that this model cannot yet say. The flag is read from the run's own coverage record, not from a list kept here, so a state drops off it the day the engine starts modelling the program.

Past the axis is not a number. Where a state's *last* danger zone runs off the top of the axis rather than closing, the safe exit is unknown; the leap is a lower bound only when the *worst* zone is the one that runs off. The two can differ, so a state can show an exact leap and no safe exit. Those cells read *past the axis* here and must not be charted as a value.

Run of Sep 17, 2026 on policyengine-us 2.6.2. Licence: AGPL-3.0-only.
Estimates only — a caseworker decides real benefits.

Cite as: HotGap, *What a raise costs, state by state*, 2026 rules on PolicyEngine (policyengine-us 2.6.2), run of Sep 17, 2026, <http://127.0.0.1:5199/places.html?household=single-2&measure=biggestLoss&sort=state>.